



Ethiopian
Community
Los Angeles

2024 Annual Report

January - August, 2024



Prepared:
September 17, 2024



Table Of Content

Who We Are

Our Values

Meet Our Team

Executive Summary

Service Programs

Testimonials

Volunteer Spotlight

Financial Report

Grant Acknowledgment

Our Partners

Who We Are

Vision

The Ethiopian Community Los Angeles, ECLA, is an inclusive, nonpolitical, and nonreligious civic organization aiming to address the social, economic, and educational needs of Ethiopian immigrants, and others in similar situations, residing in the Greater Los Angeles area of Southern California. ECLA is committed to promote the history and the cultural heritage of Ethiopia at large.

Mission

Our vision is to see Ethiopian immigrants in Los Angeles and its surroundings be fully integrated, united, equally addressed, and benefitted from the socio-economic and educational opportunities available in the country while advancing their cultural heritage and history.

Our Values

- We promote inclusiveness, so members feel safe, respected, and comfortable in expressing all aspects of their identities.
- We celebrate the diversity and autonomy of individual members.
- We empower members to willingly give service with transparency and accountability.
- We practice responsible stewardship of resources, as well as expenditures in pursuance of our organization's mission.
- We intentionally encourage intergenerational social interactions to facilitate the acquisition of language, culture, and history.
- We respond to our communities responsively by acting as a bridge to link community members to existing social and governmental programs.
- We practice transparency by committing to sharing publicly our financial records, focusing on results, and sharing the data to display impact.
- We secure trust by being accountable to each other, to the mission, to our members, donors, partners, and to the public.



Meet Our Team

BOARD OF DIRECTORS

YEKUNO WOLDEYESUS

BOARD CHAIR

SAMSON MULUGETA

BOARD SECRETARY

YONAS ASSEFA

BOARD PUBLIC RELATIONS

MEKONNEN GAREDEW

BOARD MEMBER

MESFIN KINFU

BOARD MEMBER

GUENET YOHANNES

BOARD MEMBER

MELAT LULSEGED

BOARD VICE-CHAIR

HEZKEAL AYELE

BOARD TREASURER

JHAILA BROWN

BOARD MEMBER

FASIKA KEBEDE

BOARD MEMBER

MESSERET YILMA

BOARD MEMBER

ADVISORY BOARD

FASSIL ABEBE

HANNIBAL KASSAYE

SAMUEL WOLDEYOHANES

TAYECH GEBI

GETACHEW TAMRAT



Executive Summary

ECLA is a mid-sized nonprofit organization that serves as a hub for Ethiopian immigrants throughout California. It is governed by an eleven-member board, an executive director that oversees operations, and an advisory board that supports the board by advising on governance and policy. Our membership-based organization is accountable to its members through annual general assemblies and election boards that guide leadership selection.

Operating as a virtual nonprofit, ECLA partners with twenty-five local nonprofits and county offices to offer a range of services to its community. The membership spans across multiple zip codes and is primarily composed of older, bilingual individuals, many of whom have been in the U.S. for over 40 years, while others are recent arrivals needing assistance integrating into the greater society. Our services aim to address both short- and long-term needs through a variety of programs and services.

With an annual revenue of \$50,000 to \$60,000, supplemented by small grants from banks and foundations, we organize 3-4 fundraising campaigns annually and sell merchandise at events. Our 3-4 contracted staff, alongside a dedicated group of 30-40 volunteers, work to deliver essential services. Additionally, we were awarded a \$750,000 HUD grant 18 months ago, which we are working towards augmenting to purchase a center for the community.

We encounter several challenges, including limited staffing, constrained funding, data management difficulties, and the need to enhance our team's capacity and impact. As we develop long-term strategies for the complex, community-driven initiatives we're pursuing, we recognize the importance of taking incremental steps toward achieving our goals. Continuously seeking opportunities to integrate and align our programs, we aim to drive stronger, more cohesive outcomes.

Hirout Dagnaw
Executive Director



Service Programs

ECLA's core services are structured into seven programs, all primarily staffed by volunteers, many of whom are professionals in their respective fields:

1. Mental Health Services: In collaboration with NAMI and LA County, we host workshops on topics such as suicide prevention and substance abuse. We have launched a monthly Young Adult Peer Support Group on Wednesdays, and a monthly Adult Support Group on Thursdays. Support Groups are facilitated by clinicians, associates, and social workers. We support local clinics by offering culturally appropriate mental health support through our network of Ethiopian clinicians. This coming year we would like to actively engage with community leaders to understand and address specific cultural or linguistic barriers to care. We plan to organize public events to promote mental health literacy and open conversations about mental well-being. **80 Assisted through Call Center**

2. Medical Health: Most of our work revolves around finding medical resources, insurance access, and issues around Medicare benefits. We host health and annual insurance fairs at faith-based organizations and partner clinics, and match callers to health clinics. This coming year we plan to enhance access to healthcare for our underserved community members who lack resources by organizing community outreach programs and pro bono services. We will organize support groups on topics such as nutrition, exercise, and disease prevention. We will also address common parenting challenges, stress management, and coping strategies. **40 Call Center/Insurance Fair**

3. Immigration Services: We offer immigration-related workshops every eight weeks in partnership with BAJI and provide pro bono legal services and immigration clinics. Our call center serves as a key resource for immigration-related inquiries. We will continue to facilitate the integration of immigrants into the broader community by organizing events, workshops, and programs that encourage interactions, cultural exchange, and mutual understanding between immigrants and long-term residents to create an inclusive and welcoming environment. We will continue to establish strong partnerships and collaborations with legal clinics and community organizations to better support immigrants in the community and maximize its impact and improve the overall outcomes for immigrants. **159 Referrals to Pro Bono Services**

4. Senior Services: A weekly One Stop at the Inglewood Senior Center assists bilingual seniors with housing applications, insurance, nutrition, and transportation needs. Volunteers include retired professionals such as teachers, social workers, pharmacists, and nurses. One of our priorities is to build and maintain social connections by organizing regular social events and group outings. We will also work on hosting more workshops on topics like healthy aging, nutrition, and stress management. **200 Assisted at Senior Center/ through Call Center**

5. **Youth Services:** We have moved our weekly Amharic language classes online and we are reaching more youth. We also offer STEM mentoring, tutoring, and sport clinics. We host multigenerational picnics to foster community involvement and this year we have launched a Young Adult Peer Space monthly support group, with the youth driving the agenda. We will move forward with career exploration workshops and internships to equip youth with the skills, knowledge, and networks necessary for successful career paths. **130 Participants**

6. **Social/Cultural Services:** ECLA hosts annual cultural events, including fundraising dinners, festivals, book signings, and picnics. We will continue to celebrate Ethiopian traditions, customs, music, dance, art, and cuisine to foster a sense of pride among community members and help preserve Ethiopian heritage for future generations. This year we look forward to partnering with other cultural and community organizations to promote cross- cultural understanding and inclusivity within the wider community, to foster mutual respect and appreciation for diversity.

12,355 Engagement with ECLA

7. **Parent Education:** Workshops, parent training sessions, and community events are regularly held to support the development of strong family structures. ECLA is a trusted resource within the Ethiopian community, receiving calls from around California and facilitating resource referrals.

With an eye toward growth, our current focus is to expand funding and secure a permanent center to better serve the evolving needs of the community.



Testimonials

“This past year I was having trouble with my employer over a lost paycheck, and I tried to resolve the issue for over a year. I completed a lot of paperwork and made many visits to my employer’s main office without any success. I almost gave up. I went to ECLA and met Ms. Tedjitou and Ms. Megdella who helped me resolve my problem. The Ethiopian Community has been a great help to me. We need to support this team because they represent us. May God bless this community and keep bringing together our future generations.”
Meaza Alemu

““Since I started visiting the Senior Center, I am impressed to see how ECLA is striving to help our community. I encourage all Ethiopians to reach out to help others or get the help they need through this community organization. I would like to thank the devoted volunteers helping the Seniors’ community.”
Ethiopia Mehari

Volunteer Spotlight



SELAM YEHDEGO

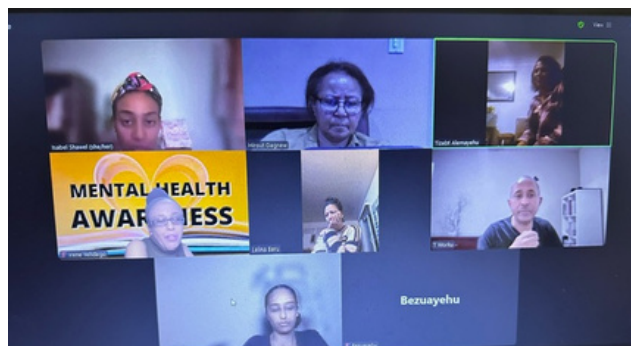
A TRUE ADVOCATE FOR MENTAL HEALTH

At our organization, we are privileged to work with volunteers who go above and beyond for our community, and Selam is a shining example of that dedication. Her passion for mental health is not just her chosen field but a calling that drives her to make a real difference in the lives of others. Selam has been an invaluable leader, especially during the challenges of the COVID-19 pandemic. When the world was in crisis, she stepped up without hesitation to address the urgent mental health needs of our community. Her ability to find solutions for clients is unmatched, whether it's through direct support or by connecting them with the resources they need. Her networking skills are exceptional, and she has a unique gift for bringing mental health professionals together to collaborate and strengthen the services we provide.

Most recently, Selam played a key role in launching mental health support groups—an initiative that has already begun making a profound impact on the caliber of professionals it has attracted. Leading her mental health team with compassion and efficiency, she ensures that every client's needs are met with care. Even with her busy life, she finds time to prioritize the well-being of others, a testament to her commitment to our mission.

Not only does Selam take the initiative in all that she does, but she also makes the extra effort to interpret at workshops, ensuring that language is never a barrier to receiving help. Her ability to create bilingual documents for the organization further ensures that our services are inclusive and accessible to all members of our community. Her kind, supportive nature resonates throughout the organization. She is always there for her fellow volunteers, offering a helping hand or words of encouragement, making her an essential part of our family.

Selam, thank you for your unwavering dedication, leadership, and compassion. You truly embody the spirit of volunteerism, and we are incredibly fortunate to have you on our team.





TEDJITOU DESSALEGN

A BEACON OF CARE AND COMPASSION

For the past two years, Tedjitou has been the heart and soul of our Seniors' Team, serving with unparalleled dedication, empathy, and an unwavering commitment to our elder community. Her journey began by simply knocking on doors, canvassing the neighborhood to better understand the needs of our senior citizens. What started as an introduction soon blossomed into deep, meaningful relationships built on trust, care, and mutual respect.

With her sharp intuition and genuine compassion, Tedjiou took it upon herself to develop a program that has become a lifeline for so many. She has visited seniors in their homes, listened to their concerns, and gone above and beyond to ensure their voices are heard. At times, she has even accompanied them to various offices, acting as an advocate and supporter, helping them navigate the complex systems to get the assistance they need.

What makes Tedjitou truly exceptional is her ability to listen—not just to the words, but to the unspoken struggles our elders face. She doesn't rest until she finds a solution, tirelessly seeking ways to alleviate their burdens and enhance their quality of life. Through her actions, she has shown time and time again that she is not just a volunteer, but a true friend and champion to the seniors she serves. Under her leadership, the Seniors' Program has grown into something extraordinary—a community built on kindness, respect, and a shared sense of belonging.

Thank you, Tedjitou, for your tireless dedication, your compassionate heart, and for showing us what it truly means to care. You are a shining light in our community, and we are forever grateful for the difference you continue to make in the lives of our seniors.





MARTHA NEGASH

AN EXEMPLARY VOLUNTEER

At ECLA, we are incredibly fortunate to have an extraordinary volunteer like Martha, whose unwavering commitment and boundless energy truly set her apart. Martha is the kind of person who steps up wherever needed, whether it's organizing materials, initiating and participating in fundraising campaigns, or recruiting new members weekly. She is always ready to lend a hand, going above and beyond to ensure that our organization has what it needs to thrive.

Martha is a forward thinker, constantly on the lookout for ways to save money, make money, and strengthen our efforts. Her strategic mindset and proactive approach have helped us seize countless opportunities, and her generosity knows no bounds. She can galvanize those around her whenever we are in a bind, ensuring that we have the resources to succeed.

Her passion for promoting our mission is evident at every gathering she attends, where she enthusiastically shares our vision and recruits new supporters. Martha's dedication is truly selfless, and her contributions have made a lasting impact on both our team and the communities we serve. We are beyond grateful for Martha's tireless efforts and her unwavering belief in our cause.

Thank you, Martha, for being the heart and soul of our volunteer team!



Financial Report

Profits & Loss

January - August, 2024

REVENUE	TOTAL
General Donation	250.00
Board Pledge	4,195.00
Grants from other nonprofits	300.00
Grants from others	5,000.00
Total General Donation	9,745.00
Membership Fee	4,440.00
Migrant Fund	1,600.00
<u>Non-Profit Revenue</u>	
Event Fund Raising Revenue	23,765.00
Total Non-Profit Revenue	23,765.00
Total Revenue	39,550.00
GROSS PROFIT	39,550.00
EXPENDITURES	
Accounting & Book-keeping Services	3,200.00
Consulting Fee	1,340.00
Fundraising Expenses	1,391.77
Catering	7,105.00
Hall Rental Fees	3,054.29
Music	2,775.00
Other Expenses	1,802.53
Total Fundraising Expenses	16,128.59
<u>Insurance</u>	
Directors & officers insurance	1,250.00

Total Insurance	1,250.00
New Immigrants Program	2,200.00
<u>Occupancy</u>	
Facilities Rent	815.00
Utilities	644.25
Total Occupancy	1,459.25
Office expenses	18.35
Bank fees & service charges	292.44
Memberships & subscriptions	75.00
Office supplies	29.29
Shipping & postage	126.03
Software & apps	2,299.76
Total Office expenses	2,840.87
Outside services	500.00
Promotional Items - T-Shirts	2,000.00
Taxes, License, and Fees	25.00
Total Expenditures	30,943.71
NET OPERATING REVENUE	8,606.29
NET REVENUE	\$8,606.29

Balance Sheet

As of August 31, 2024

ASSETS	TOTAL
<u>Current Assets</u>	
Bank Accounts	
TOTAL BUS CHK (9869) - 1	17,378.26
Total Bank Accounts	17,378.26
Accounts Receivable	
Accounts Receivable (A/R)	5,000.00
Total Accounts Receivable	5,000.00
Other Current Assets	
Other receivables	221.55
Prepays and Deposits	26,000.00
Total Other Current Assets	26,221.55
Total Current Assets	48,599.81
TOTAL ASSETS	\$48,599.81
LIABILITIES AND EQUITY	
<u>Liabilities</u>	
Current Liabilities	
Other Current Liabilities	
Deferred Revenue	660.00
Total Other Current Liabilities	660.00
Total Current Liabilities	660.00
Total Liabilities	660.00
<u>Equity</u>	
Opening balance equity	9,641.65
Retained Earnings	29,691.87
Net Revenue	8,606.29
Total Equity	47,939.81
TOTAL LIABILITIES AND EQUITY	\$48,599.81

2024 Grant Acknowledgment

★ Conrad N Hilton Foundation

★ First Citizens Bank

A huge thank you
to all our ardent
supporters, members,
donors, and incredible
volunteers!

Our partners

